

Physical computing

One of the most exciting things about DIY electronics kits, such as the Raspberry Pi, Arduino, or micro:bit, is their potential for physical computing. Physical computing connects the digital world inside a computer to the physical world, using cameras, LEDs, sensors, and other inputs and outputs.



△ Things to make

Physical computing has been used in many projects, such as remote-controlled robots, voice-activated lights, computer-controlled cameras on weather balloons to capture photos from space, and many others.

BIOGRAPHY

Bill Gates

Born in 1955, American entrepreneur Bill Gates started programming in his early teens. In 1975, he set up the technology company Microsoft (the name combines “microcomputer” with “software”) with his friend Paul Allen. Microsoft have become famous for their Windows operating systems, programs like Word, Excel, and Outlook, and the Xbox gaming console, among many other things.



Maker Movement

In recent years, there's been a rise in popularity of the Maker Movement, where people get together and build DIY projects using traditional crafts and modern electronics. Makerspaces, Fab Labs, Hackerspaces, and similar collaborative spaces exist in many cities, enabling people to share their ideas, time, and resources.

Online resources ▾

For people who don't have access to makerspaces there are many project ideas and instructions available online. Free how-to guides for a variety of projects can be found on sites, such as Make, Instructables, and AdaFruit.

“The Maker Movement is about moving from consumption to creation, and turning knowledge into action.”

Laura Fleming,
educator, makerspace author

